DSEH004 · PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT AND EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT

Writing the Board Memo and the Final Presentation Brief

Week 11 · Lecture 3 · Unit IV · The pyramid principle, persuasion, evidence based management and HR as decision science

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L3 · COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

A Board Memo should show all of your analysis.

Agree or disagree. What does a Board need to decide?

L3 · STRUCTURE

Minto's pyramid principle

Answer first

Lead with the recommendation, then the grouped reasons beneath it.

Situation, complication, question

Open with what the reader knows, what has changed, and the question that follows.

Group and order

Each level summarizes the ideas below it, in a logical order.

Minto (2009)

Conger (1998)

Credibility

Expertise and relationships earn the right to be heard.

Common ground

Frame the proposal in terms of the Board's own goals.

Vivid evidence

Data with examples and stories that make it concrete.

Emotional connection

Show you understand what the decision costs those making it.

Four sources of evidence

SOURCE	IN YOUR MEMO
Scientific literature	The theories and studies from this course
Organizational data	The Bharat Textiles dataset, with columns named
Practitioner expertise	What your rounds taught you
Stakeholder concerns	Managers, employees, the four anchors

Rousseau (2006); Barends, Rousseau and Briner (2014)

HR as a decision science

BOUDREAU AND RAMSTAD (2007)

Pivotal talent

Invest where a change in performance changes strategic outcomes most.

At Bharat Textiles

Is the pivot the 688 managers? Make the case with data.

Formats

1 **Board Memo**
1,500 words plus or minus 50, in the four section structure in the Round 6 brief, written in the portal by the Pod Lead, with a Learning Log.

2 **Presentation**
12 minutes per pod in Week 12: 10 minutes of presentation and 2 minutes of questions.

3 **Also due**
Reflection Log 3 and peer evaluation, as shown in the portal.

REFERENCES

Sources for this lecture (1 of 1)

Barends, E., Rousseau, D. M., and Briner, R. B. (2014). Evidence Based Management: The Basic Principles. Center for Evidence Based Management.

Boudreau, J. W., and Ramstad, P. M. (2007). Beyond HR: The New Science of Human Capital. Harvard Business School Press.

Conger, J. A. (1998). The necessary art of persuasion. Harvard Business Review, 76(3), 84 to 95.

Minto, B. (2009). The Pyramid Principle (3rd ed.). Pearson.

Rousseau, D. M. (2006). Is there such a thing as evidence based management? Academy of Management Review, 31(2), 256 to 269.